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Google Pixel 9a review

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PIXEL 9A

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1. Introduction, specs, unboxing

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Introduction

Google's "A-series" of devices remains the most affordable entry point into the Pixel ecosystem on a current generation device. The search giant didn't really introduce any massive changes to the formula this year, but there are still changes to consider.

GSMArena Official

0:03 / 8:22 Intro

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The design has been updated and is now flatter and more in line with the other Pixel 9 devices. The display has grown a bit since last year and is now 6.3 inches instead of 6.1. It is brighter as well. All the while, the device's overall footprint hasn't changed much, and neither its thickness nor weight has been affected. The latter point is particularly impressive since the Pixel 9a has the biggest battery out of any pixel to date at 5,100 mAh.

Mitsubishi shows the Eclipse Sportback, which looks very familiar

Lucid Gravity gets hands-free highway driving, adaptive beam headlights through new update

Apple introduces new CarPlay features with iOS 27, video apps to be allowed

- > **Body:** 154.7x73.3x8.9mm, 186g; Glass front (Gorilla Glass), aluminum frame, plastic back; IP68 dust-tight and water resistant (immersible up to 1.5m for 30 min).
- > **Display:** 6.30" P-OLED, HDR, 120Hz, 1800 nits (HBM), 2700 nits (peak), 1080x2424px resolution, 20.2:9 aspect ratio, 422ppi; Always-on display.
- > **Chipset:** Google Tensor G4 (4 nm): Octa-core (1x3.1 GHz Cortex-X4 & 3x2.6 GHz Cortex-A720 & 4x1.9 GHz Cortex-A520); Mali-G715 MP7.
- > **Memory:** 128GB 8GB RAM, 256GB 8GB RAM; UFS 3.1.
- > **OS/Software:** Android 15, up to 7 major Android upgrades.
- > **Rear camera:** Wide (main): 48 MP, f/1.7, 25mm, 1/2.0", 0.8µm, dual pixel PDAF, OIS; Ultra wide angle: 13 MP, f/2.2, 120-degree, 1/3.1", 1.12µm.
- > **Front camera:** 13 MP, f/2.2, 20mm (ultrawide), 1/3.1", 1.12µm.
- > **Video capture:** Rear camera: 4K@30/60fps, 1080p@30/60/120/240fps, gyro-EIS, OIS; Front camera: 4K@30fps, 1080p@30fps.
- > **Battery:** 5100mAh; 23W wired, PD3.0, 7.5W wireless, Bypass charging (w/ "Limit to 80%" option enabled).
- > **Connectivity:** 5G; eSIM; Wi-Fi region; BT 5.3; NFC.
- > **Misc:** Fingerprint reader (under display, optical); stereo speakers; Circle to Search.

The camera setup has also been upgraded, and so has the chipset. You now get a Tensor G4 chipset. That brings about some other niceties, like a dual-band GPS. Also likely related is the upgraded battery charging rate of 23W.



In keeping with tradition, the Pixel 9a offers the core Pixel experience, including a computational camera and various tools, AI and otherwise, on a budget. At current pricing, the regular Pixel 9 is admittedly a bit close, but that doesn't necessarily mean the Pixel 9a is bad value. Read along as we dig into the matter further.

Unboxing

The Pixel 9a ships in a cardboard two-piece box with a cardboard sleeve on top that is printed in a color matching your unit. That's a smart cost-cutting measure right there. The box itself isn't the toughest and hardest we've seen, but it should still protect the phone just fine in shipping. Plus, we appreciate that it is eco-friendly, with zero plastic in and out.



Unsurprisingly, you don't get much in the way of accessories. The Pixel 9a just ships with a single USB Type-C to Type-C cable. No charger and no additional accessories are present.

[NEXT PAGE »](#) **2. Design, build quality, handling**

1. Introduction, specs, unboxing

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PIXEL 9A

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GOOGLE PIXEL 9A REVIEW - READER COMMENTS

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?
Downgraded main cam? Especially when Google never even gives details of their semsors which are just guessed. "Both wider and brighter than last year's" You clearly meant the other way?
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?
The best thing about thw phone is about its battery. And Worse is it's buzzles
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?
The only real advantage of the pixel 9a is the size. I dont know a single person who owns a phone bigger than 6,4" and they ALL want to size DOWN....we are not a huge market over here in Germany, but most people I see rock the smallest versions ...
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